



Novonesis - Microbiogen

MN-10030

Phase 1 Determination

Acquisition may be put into effect

14 September 2026

1. Determination and statement of reasons

Notified acquisition	Novonesis A/S (Novonesis) proposes to indirectly acquire 100% of the share capital of Microbiogen Pty Ltd (Microbiogen) through its wholly owned subsidiary, Novozymes Australia Pty Ltd (Novozymes) (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABZE(1) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition may be put into effect.
Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Novonesis, is a global biotechnology company headquartered in Denmark. Novonesis manufactures and supplies enzymes and microorganisms for industrial applications across multiple sectors. In Australia, it operates through its wholly owned subsidiary Novozymes, which operates as the regional sales, distribution and technical support arm of Novonesis in Australia and New Zealand. Novonesis is majority owned and controlled by Novo Holdings A/S, which is in turn wholly owned by the Novo Nordisk Foundation, an independent enterprise foundation based in Denmark. The target, Microbiogen, is a biotechnology company based in Australia. Microbiogen is active in the research and development of yeast strains for industrial applications across a range of sectors, including biofuels, baking, food, animal feed, beverages and biochemicals.
Overlap and relationship between the Parties	Novonesis and Microbiogen (the Parties) are both active in the supply of yeast products, however Microbiogen supplies yeast strain research and development and intellectual property, while Novonesis is a manufacturer and supplier of commercial yeast products. The Parties have a vertical relationship as Microbiogen develops proprietary yeast strains for use by Novonesis. Novonesis currently holds an existing minority shareholding in Microbiogen and via the Acquisition proposes to indirectly acquire the outstanding share capital in Microbiogen that it does not already own.
Reasons for determination	When making a determination in Phase 1, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (ACCC) undertakes a competition assessment and considers whether it is appropriate for an acquisition to be approved or subject to further assessment in Phase 2 in accordance with section 51ABZJ of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). In doing so, the ACCC must have regard to the object of the Act and all relevant matters, including the interests of consumers. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notified acquisitions, see the ACCC's merger assessment guidelines and interim merger process guidelines. In conducting its competition assessment, the ACCC has considered the information and documents that were submitted with the notification form and publicly available information. The ACCC has determined that the Acquisition may be put into

	effect as it considers that the Acquisition would be unlikely to have the effect of substantially lessening competition in any market. In reaching its decision, and based on the material before it, the ACCC makes the following findings. • There is no horizontal overlap between the Parties. • Novonesis would not have the ability and incentive to foreclose rivals' access to yeast strain research and development services and associated intellectual property post-Acquisition given the alternative providers of these services.
Applications for review	A notifying party, or other person who has been allowed to do so by the Australian Competition Tribunal, may apply for review if they are dissatisfied with the determination. Pursuant to section 100C of the Act, applications for review of the determination are to be made to the Australian Competition Tribunal before the end of 14 calendar days after this statement of reasons was included on the ACCC's Acquisitions Register. To confirm whether there has been any application for review, please contact the Australian Competition Tribunal.

**Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1)
of the Act**